

Committee on National Security Systems

**CNSSD No. 520
November 2021**



THE USE OF MOBILE DEVICES TO PROCESS NATIONAL SECURITY INFORMATION OUTSIDE OF SECURE SPACES

**THIS DOCUMENT PROVIDES BASELINE GOVERNANCE AND
PROCEDURES FOR THE COMMITTEE ON NATIONAL SECURITY
SYSTEMS (CNSS). YOUR DEPARTMENT OR AGENCY MAY
REQUIRE FURTHER IMPLEMENTATION.**



Committee on National Security Systems

RECORD OF CHANGE

Version	Date of Change	Section/Figure Changed	Description of Change
November 2021	November 2021	All	Updated formatting and references



Committee on National Security Systems

CHAIR

FOREWORD

1. The Committee on National Security Systems (CNSS) Directive (CNSSD) No. 520, Directive on The Use of Mobile Devices to Process National Security Information (NSI) Outside of Secure Spaces, provides specific instructions for the control and use of mobile devices that are intended to store, process, and transmit NSI outside of secure spaces, both domestically and limited overseas, to ensure that mobile devices are protected commensurate to the threat environment and level of information stored, processed, transmitted, or communicated.

2. Implementation of this Directive does not satisfy or supersede the requirements of other operations or security programs such as TEMPEST, Communications Security (COMSEC), Operations Security (OPSEC), or Overseas Security Policy Board (OSPB) standards.

3. This Directive is effective upon signature.

5. Additional copies of this directive are available at the address listed below or via the CNSS website (www.cnss.gov).

/s/

JOHN W. WILMER, III

CNSS Secretariat National Security Agency. 9800 Savage Road, Suite 6165 - Ft Meade MD 20755-6165
(410)-854-6805
cnss@nsa.gov

DIRECTIVE ON THE USE OF MOBILE DEVICES TO PROCESS NATIONAL SECURITY INFORMATION OUTSIDE OF SECURE SPACES

	<u>SECTION</u>
PURPOSE	I
AUTHORITY	II
SCOPE	III
POLICY	IV
RESPONSIBILITIES	V
DEFINITIONS.....	VI
REFERENCES	VII
ANNEX A: RESOURCES.....	A-1
ANNEX B: ACRONYMS.....	B-1

DIRECTIVE ON THE USE OF MOBILE DEVICES TO PROCESS NATIONAL SECURITY INFORMATION OUTSIDE OF SECURE SPACES

SECTION I – Purpose

1. The United States Government (USG) has become more reliant on highly capable mobile technologies, which provide users with increasingly sophisticated functionality, including Command and Control and Continuity of Operations (COOP) capabilities for the senior leadership of USG Departments and Agencies (D/As). However, the use of mobile devices, approved for processing NSI outside of secure spaces may lead to the unintentional disclosure of NSI.

2. This Directive provides the minimum set of requirements for the use of mobile devices that store, process, or transmit (including voice discussions) NSI outside of secure spaces. D/As may develop additional policies and procedures to supplement the requirements of this Directive, as needed.

3. In addition to the requirements of this Directive, D/As must mitigate or accept the risk associated with the use of mobile devices used to store, process, or transmit NSI outside of approved secure spaces, consistent with CNSS Policy (CNSSP) No. 22, Cybersecurity Risk Management (Reference a).

SECTION II – AUTHORITY

4. This Directive derives its authority from National Security Directive (NSD) 42, National Policy for the Security of National Security Telecommunications and Information Systems (Reference b) and Executive Order (E.O.) 12333, United States Intelligence Activities (Reference c), as amended.

5. Nothing in this directive shall alter or supersede the authorities of the Director of National Intelligence.

SECTION III – SCOPE

6. This Directive applies to all USG D/A employees, contractors, and authorized agents, herein after referred to as “users”, who use mobile devices that store, process, or transmit NSI (including voice discussions) outside of approved secure spaces.

7. This Directive applies to all mobile devices that store, process, or transmit NSI (including voice discussions), herein after referred to as “classified mobile devices”.

8. Devices that process Sensitive Compartmented Information (SCI) shall comply with all requirements promulgated by and under the authority of the Director of National Intelligence (DNI).

SECTION IV – POLICY

9. The use of classified mobile devices outside of secure spaces is authorized when approved by the D/A's Authorizing Official (AO) or designee, in consultation with appropriate authorities and in accordance with the requirements contained herein.

10. Only documented, authorized users with an active and verified individual personnel security clearance at a level equal to, or greater than, the classification level of data or information being stored, processed, transmitted, or communicated, may use, or have access to, a classified mobile device.

11. Classified mobile devices shall be approved by the National Manager prior to storing, processing, transmitting, or communicating NSI. These devices shall conform to all requirements for the protection of classified voice and data transmission, processing, and storage, commensurate with the level approved for the device by the National Manager.

12. The D/A's AO or designee shall document, in writing, the authorization for use of classified mobile devices in their appropriate risk management framework to include the artifacts for the system in which the device will be associated.

13. D/A users shall only use classified voice and/or data capabilities on classified mobile devices outside of secure spaces when there is a mission need.

14. NSI stored, processed, and/or transmitted on classified mobile devices shall be categorized in accordance with Executive Order 13526 (reference d).

15. Classified mobile devices used to store, process, transmit, or communicate NSI shall use a National Security Agency (NSA)-approved solution to protect data (e.g., encrypt), whether at rest or in transit, in accordance with CNSSP No. 15 (Reference e) and CNSS Policy No. 17 (Reference f).

16. D/As deploying a Commercial Solution for Classified (CSfC) mobility solution shall configure that solution according to NSA-developed Capability Packages (CPs) (e.g., Mobile Access Capability Package), as described in CNSSP No. 7, Policy on the Use of Commercial Solutions to Protect National Security Systems (Reference g). D/As using a non-CSfC classified mobile solution shall collaborate with the NSA to develop a National Manager-approved solution.

NOTE: The implementation of a CSfC solution in accordance with reference (g) may not include all security requirements and controls associated with the security and protection of a NSS and/or NSI (e.g., physical security, TEMPEST, Operations Security).

17. D/As utilizing COMSEC material as a component of a classified mobile solution must comply with all policy and doctrine associated with that COMSEC item.

18. AOs will review the risk assessment documented in accordance with reference (g) prior to implementing a classified mobile solution.

19. In accordance with the OPSEC program established by National Security Decision Directive 298, National Operations Security Program (Reference h), D/As implementing classified mobile devices outside of secure spaces shall:

a. Adhere to the D/A's OPSEC requirements when deploying such devices outside of secure spaces;

b. Document and incorporate the use of classified mobile devices in the D/A's OPSEC program implemented under reference (h);

c. Inform device users of their responsibility to adhere to OPSEC when using the device outside of secure spaces;

d. Ensure classified mobile devices are not marked with any external/visible classification label(s). If, or when, device cases are used, diversification is encouraged;

e. Ensure that, if used, any indications (e.g. consent banners, screen colors, markings, etc.) of USG ownership or classification level of the information and/or device are discreet. The use of indications shall be weighed against the risk of awareness by unauthorized personnel;

f. Not advertise or post specific information about classified mobile device solutions, including, but not limited to device type, solution configuration, device security characteristics, or any other non-public data. Additionally, D/As shall ensure that the classified mobile device and solution artifacts are classified in accordance with the appropriate security classification guide; and

g. Use a privacy screen protector on all classified mobile devices, as appropriate.

20. Prior to issuance and use of a classified mobile device, D/As must develop, and users must sign, a user agreement that specifies, at a minimum:

a. The approved operating environment to include the Continental United States (CONUS), outside CONUS, and high threat areas, as well as technical, environmental, human, and intelligence collection risks, and any user mitigations to avoid monitoring, collection, or interception of NSI;

b. The user's responsibilities to adhere to OPSEC when operating outside of secure spaces;

- c. The monitoring requirements that the user must consent to prior to using the device;
 - d. The classification level of the information stored, processed, or transmitted on the device shall not exceed the approved classification level of either the device or the user's personnel clearance level;
 - e. The acknowledgement by the user that they have been trained to properly use the classified mobile device and will only connect the classified mobile device to authorized Information Systems (IS), accessories, or stations for charging, tethering, or docking purposes;
 - f. The user's responsibility to maintain physical control of the classified mobile device, both when the device is powered on and the user has access to NSI (i.e. is logged in) as well as when powered off (e.g., storage requirements);
 - g. The user's responsibility to immediately report incidents, including lost or stolen classified mobile devices, signs of tampering, or data spillage and immediate actions if the device is, or is suspected to be, compromised or in the event of a failure of the devices' security operations (e.g., failure to operate as intended);
 - h. The prohibition of a user modifying, updating, or altering device software or hardware;
 - i. Procedures for, or prohibition of, introduction of the classified mobile device into that D/A's secure spaces, as appropriate;
 - j. Procedures for returning the device for periodic updates (software and/or security patches) and end of life procedures; and
 - k. Specific requirements for periodic user training.
21. Users shall only utilize D/A-approved accessories (such as cases, extended life batteries, and charging accessories) for classified mobile devices.
22. When a security incident is reported or occurs, D/As will ensure appropriate measures are taken to rectify the situation to include: a written record of the incident, any remedial actions by security or counterintelligence staff, and notification of appropriate security authorities.
23. Data spillage incidents must be resolved in accordance with CNSSP No. 18, National Policy on Classified Information Spillage (Reference i).
24. Classified mobile devices shall, where feasible, incorporate anti-tamper features to prevent unauthorized alterations to the device, or to alert the user that the device may have been improperly modified. Users shall alert the appropriate security authority at their D/A to any suspected tampering.

25. Classified mobile devices shall be managed and tracked by a Mobile Device Management (MDM) system, or a comparable solution, which provides the controlling D/A the ability to remotely control, monitor, disable, delete, add, and remove data and/or functionality from the device.

26. D/As shall maintain records of classified mobile devices that are issued for use outside of secure spaces. These records shall include, at a minimum: the name and organization of the user, the type of device (manufacturer/model), serial number, phone number, the classification of data that the device may process, store, or transmit and conditions of its use.

27. In accordance with CNSS Directive (CNSSD) No. 504, Directive on Protecting National Security Systems from Insider Threat (Reference j), D/As shall ensure that procedures are in place to mitigate the risk of a classified mobile device user disclosing NSI to unauthorized personnel, either intentionally or inadvertently.

SECTION V – Responsibilities

28. The National Manager shall:

- a. Approve (or disapprove) classified mobile devices and their implementation.
- b. Develop, issue, and maintain standards and guidance for the development and implementation of classified mobile devices.

Note: NSA guidance includes, but is not limited to, CSfC CPs and National Information Assurance Partnership Protection Profiles (as stated in CNSSP No. 11, *National Policy Governing the Acquisition of Information Assurance (IA) and IA-Enabled Information Technology Products* (Reference (k)), and specifies the requisite security requirements that must be met by a given solution or product in order to obtain NSA approval. D/As are responsible for determining internal policies and procedures governing the implementation of those devices in accordance with NSA guidelines.

- c. Advise D/As when developing classified mobile solutions.
- d. Issue supporting CNSS SCRM guidance as necessary.

29. Heads of D/As shall:

- a. Develop, implement, and manage programs necessary to ensure that the requirements of this Directive are implemented and adequately resourced.
- b. Evaluate the mission need and risk of using classified mobile devices outside of secure spaces, and make a risk determination as to the scope of mobility efforts implemented under this Directive;

c. Ensure that authorized users sign a user agreement prior to being issued a classified mobile device;

d. Consider OPSEC requirements, best practices, and mission need when authorizing classified mobile device use outside of secure spaces;

e. Develop guidelines and training for users to follow when using a classified mobile device outside of secure spaces. These guidelines shall include, at a minimum:

1) Safeguarding and storage requirements for the classified mobile device;

2) Usage guidelines including where, when, and how to use the classified mobile device based on mission need;

3) Training to identify anomalous classified mobile device behavior and specific reporting requirements including device disposition;

4) Travel requirements including inspection and handling rules and any special requirements when traveling or assigned outside the United States that are consistent with the rules prescribed by the Department of State and those individuals or organizations operating under the Chief of Mission as per the OSPB (Reference l) or under the command of a United States area military commander; and

5) Counterintelligence, physical security, and technical security awareness information relevant to areas, including critical and high threat, in which the classified mobile device may be operated.

f. As needed, dedicate funding to the implementation of the security and training requirements in this Directive to ensure users are trained, at a minimum, annually.

SECTION VI – Definitions

30. Definitions in CNSS Instruction 4009, *National Information Assurance (IA) Glossary*, dated 26 April 2015, (Reference m) apply to this Directive. In addition, the following definitions are provided to clarify or present new terms used in this Directive.

Secure Space: A secure space is defined as a building, facility, or controlled area (whether permanent, temporary, or mobile) that meets all of the following criteria:

a. Contains NSS;

b. Is operated by a USG D/A, U.S. or Allied Military Command, an appropriately cleared contractor, or a State, Local or Tribal government;

- c. Is protected at a level commensurate with the classification or sensitivity of the information that is processed, stored, used, or discussed therein;
- d. Falls under the responsibility of a Cognizant Security Authority (CSA) or Senior Agency Official responsible for ensuring the physical and technical security of the space; and
- e. Is not an accredited Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility (SCIF) or Special Access Program Facility (SAPF).

Note: Secure spaces may include SAPFs, as well as facilities that contain nuclear command and control materials or related information, that are not SCIFs. Secure spaces may also contain NSI commensurate to the level of the accreditation of the secure space. For policy applicable in SCIFs, see Appendix B, Resources 1.f & g.

The definition of secure spaces does not apply to unclassified lab environments where mobile devices may be introduced exclusively for official research, analysis, or testing purposes. D/As will ensure that the introduction of mobile devices into lab environments does not subject sensitive information (e.g., personally identifiable information) used or stored within the space to potential compromise.

SECTION VII – References

- 31. Updates to the referenced documents shall be considered applicable to this Directive. Annex A contains a list of resources available to D/As implementing this Directive.
- 32. The following sources provide amplifying or supplementary information on NSS, Information assurance, and insider threat programs. Updates or modifications to the policies or guidance contained in the documents referenced below must be applicable to this Directive.
 - a. CNSS Policy 22 (CNSSP 22), *Information Assurance Risk Management Policy for National Security Systems*, September 2021.
 - b. National Security Directive 42, *National Policy for the Security of the National Security Telecommunications and Information Systems*, July 1990.
 - c. Executive Order 12333, United States Intelligence Activities, as amended, 30 July 2008.
 - d. Executive Order 13526, Classified National Security Information, 29 Dec 2009.

- e. CNSS Policy No. 15, National Information Assurance Policy on the Use of Public Standards for the Secure Sharing of Information Among National Security Systems, 1 October 2016.
- f. CNSS Policy No. 17, Policy on Wireless Systems, January 2014.
- g. CNSS Policy No. 7, Policy on the Use of Commercial Solutions to Protect National Security Systems, 9 December 2015.
- h. National Security Decision Directive 298, National Operations Security Program, 22 January 1988.
- i. CNSS Policy No. 18, National Policy on Classified Information Spillage, May 2021.
- j. CNSSD No. 504, Directive on Protecting National Security Systems from Insider Threat, 4 February 2014.
- k. CNSS Policy No. 11, National Policy Governing the Acquisition of Information Assurance (IA) and IA-Enabled Information Technology Products, 10 June 2013.
- l. The Overseas Security Policy Board Standards and Policy 12 FAH-6.
- m. CNSS Instruction No. 4009, Committee on National Security Systems (CNSS) Glossary, 6 April 2015.

Enclosures:

ANNEX A – Resources

ANNEX B – Acronyms

ANNEX A

RESOURCES

1. This annex is included to provide D/As and users with resources to implement and use mobile devices that process NSI outside of secure spaces.

a. CSfC Capability Packages (CPs) and Risk Assessments: NSA's CSfC program allows D/As to implement NSA-approved Commercial-Off-The-Shelf solutions to protect NSS. CSfC solutions are configured according to requirements in the applicable CP. NSA provides a classified risk assessment for each CSfC CP, providing AOs with information on the residual risk associated with a solution based on a CP (see reference g for more information). CSfC CPs and program information are located at:
https://www.nsa.gov/ia/programs/csfc_program/index.shtml.

b. Department of Defense Chief Information Officer (DoD CIO) & Undersecretary of Defense (Intelligence) (USD(I)) Joint Memorandum, "Security and Operational Guidance for Classified Portable Electronic Devices", Sept 25, 2015: DoD CIO and USD(I) developed this memorandum to enable classified mobile solutions within the DoD. This Memorandum provides general use guidance for classified mobile devices and users. Inquiries for this Memorandum should be addressed to the DoD CIO at:
DoDCIOMobilityMailbox@mail.mil.

c. CNSS Policy No. 17, Annex B: This Annex contains references to general standards and best practices documents, including relevant National Institute of Standards and Technology publications. Although these documents are not specific to using mobile devices outside secure spaces, they may be a source of information for D/As and classified mobile device users.

d. The Department of State regularly updates their web site with information based on country and/or region and provides safety and security recommendations for travelers. This guidance is recommended for users of classified mobile devices and may be found at this link: <https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/traveladvisories/traveladvisories.html/>

e. CNSS Directive No. 510, "Use of Mobile Devices within Secure Spaces", November 2017, provides a minimum set of requirements for the introduction and use of mobile devices in secure spaces.

f. ICD 705 Technical Specifications, Chapter 10: This document contains the Intelligence Community's guidelines for making risk determinations applicable to SCIFs. Generally, restrictions for SCIFs should be more stringent than secure spaces, but the guidelines

in Chapter 10 may serve as a resource for CSAs when making risk determinations for secure spaces.

g. Intelligence Community Wireless Steering Committee: Intelligence Community (IC) Wireless Steering Committee (WSC) is the primary advisory body to the Director of National Intelligence (DNI) for the introduction of wireless technology, wireless-enabled devices, and their associated infrastructure within the IC. The IC WSC comprehensively addresses wireless technology and the risk mitigation approach surrounding its use within SCIFs or connected to IC networks.

h. CNSS Policy No. 17, Policy on Wireless Systems, January 2014.

ANNEX B

ACRONYMS

AO	Authorizing Official
CNSS	Committee on National Security Systems
CNSSD	Committee on National Security Systems Directive
CNSSI	Committee on National Security Systems Instruction
CNSSP	Committee on National Security Systems Policy
COMSEC	Communications Security
CONUS	Continental United States
COOP	Continuity of Operations
CP	Capability Package
CSA	Cognizant Security Authority
CSfC	Commercial Solutions for Classified
D/A	Department/Agency
DNI	Director of National Intelligence
DoD CIO	Department of Defense Chief Information Officer
EO	Executive Order
IA	Information Assurance
IS	Information System
MDM	Mobile Device Management
NSA	National Security Agency
NSD	National Security Directive
NSI	National Security Information
NSS	National Security System
OPSEC	Operations Security
OSPB	Overseas Security Policy Board
SAPF	Special Access Program Facility
SCI	Sensitive Compartmented Information
SCIF	Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility
USD(I)	Undersecretary of Defense (Intelligence)
USG	United States Government